

Ziyang Wang

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Education

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

Ph.D. Candidate in Computer Science, advised by Prof. Mohit Bansal.

Chapel Hill, NC

Aug. 2022 - Exp. May. 2027

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill

M.S. in Computer Science, during Ph.D. study.

Chapel Hill, NC

Aug. 2022 - Exp. Dec. 2024

University of Electronic Science and Technology of China

Bachelor of Engineer, Major: Software Engineering. Overall GPA: 3.92.

Chengdu, China

Sept. 2018 - Jun. 2022

Research Interest

My research focuses on multimodal AI and agentic systems for understanding and reasoning across different modalities (especially videos). My goal is to develop effective and efficient systems that integrate perception and reasoning to solve complex real-world problems.

Work Experience

UNC-NLP

Graduate Research Assistant

Chapel Hill, NC

Aug. 2022 - PRESENT

- Advised by Prof. Mohit Bansal, also work closely with Prof. Gedas Bertasius
- Built models to tackle challenging video understanding tasks like retrieval and long video understanding.
- Published several academic papers in CV/NLP conferences including ICCV, EACL, EMNLP.

Bloomberg L.P.

Data Science Fellow and Research Intern

New York City, NY

May. 2026 - Aug. 2026

- Advised by Dr. Debanjan Mahata and Dr. Daniel Preotiuc-Pietro.
- Worked on large-scale multimodal document understanding.

Salesforce AI Research

Research Intern

Palo Alto, CA

May. 2025 - Feb. 2026

- Advised by Dr. Juan Carlos Niebles (manager), Dr. Michael S. Ryoo, Dr. Junnan Li and Dr. Honglu Zhou.
- Worked on the agentic long video understanding.
- Published "Active Video Perception: Iterative Evidence Seeking for Agentic Long Video Understanding" in CVPR 2026.

Meta FAIR Perception

Research Intern

Menlo Park, CA

May. 2024 - Dec. 2024

- Advised by Dr. Ronghang Hu (manager), Dr. Christoph Feichtenhofer, Dr. Po-Yao (Bernie) Huang and Dr. Daniel Bolya.
- Worked on the next generation video foundation encoders.
- Worked on long video encoder training and zero-shot application for short video encoder on long video tasks.

Amazon Alexa AI

Applied Scientist Intern

Seattle, WA

May. 2023 - Oct. 2023

- Advised by Dr. Heba Elfardy (manager), Dr. Kevin Small, Dr. Markus Dreyer
- Improved the multimodal large language model's ability to retrieve both visual and textual outputs.
- Published the paper named "Unified Embeddings for Multimodal Retrieval via Frozen LLMs" in EACL2024 (findings).

Tsinghua University

Research Intern, advised by Prof. Jingjing Liu

Beijing, China

Oct. 2021 - May. 2022

- Worked on a project to improve the visual question answering ability of the MLLMs.
- Also work on the project that focuses on Vehicle-Infrastructure Cooperative 3D Object Detection.

Honor

Bloomberg Data Science Ph.D. Fellowship Award

Bloomberg L.P.

New York City, NY

March. 2026

- Recognized for my research in long context multimodal understanding and multimodal agents.

Papers

- 2026 **Searching Videos as Trees: Self-Correcting Agents for Grounded Long Video QA** Atlanta, USA
Ce Zhang, **Ziyang Wang**, Yulu Pan, Oluwatumininu Oguntola, Pranav Wagh, Qiyu Wu, Hiromi Wakaki, Mohit Bansal, Gedas Bertasius
NeurIPS 2026
- 2026 **EgoMemReason: A Memory-Driven Reasoning Benchmark for Long-Horizon Egocentric Video Understanding** San Francisco, USA
Ziyang Wang*, Yue Zhang*, Shoubin Yu, Ce Zhang, Zengqi Zhao, Jaehong Yoon, Hyunji Lee, Gedas Bertasius, Mohit Bansal
COLM 2026
- 2026 **Evidence-Backed Video Question Answering** Malmö, Sweden
Shijie Wang, Honglu Zhou, **Ziyang Wang**, Ran Xu, Caiming Xiong, Silvio Savarese, Chen Sun, Juan Carlos Niebles
ECCV 2026
- 2026 **Multimodal Fact-Level Attribution for Verifiable Reasoning** South Korea
David Wan, Han Wang, **Ziyang Wang**, Elias Stengel-Eskin, Hyunji Lee, Mohit Bansal
ICML 2026
- 2026 **Active Video Perception: Iterative Evidence Seeking for Agentic Long Video Understanding** Denver, USA
Ziyang Wang, Honglu Zhou, Shijie Wang, Junnan Li, Caiming Xiong, Silvio Savarese, Mohit Bansal, Michael S. Ryoo, Juan Carlos Niebles
CVPR 2026 Findings
- 2026 **SiLVR: A Simple Language-based Video Reasoning Framework**
Ce Zhang*, Yan-Bo Lin*, **Ziyang Wang**, Mohit Bansal, Gedas Bertasius
TMLR 2026
- 2026 **TimeRefine: Temporal Grounding with Time Refining Video LLM** Tucson, USA
Xizi Wang, Feng Cheng, **Ziyang Wang**, Huiyu Wang, Md Mohaiminul Islam, Lorenzo Torresani, Mohit Bansal, Gedas Bertasius, David Crandall
WACV 2026
- 2025 **Video-RTS: Rethinking Reinforcement Learning and Test-Time Scaling for Efficient and Enhanced Video Reasoning** Suzhou, China
Ziyang Wang*, Jaehong Yoon*, Shoubin Yu, Md Mohaiminul Islam, Gedas Bertasius, Mohit Bansal
EMNLP 2025 Main
- 2025 **MEXA: Towards General Multimodal Reasoning with Dynamic Multi-Expert Aggregation** Suzhou, China
Shoubin Yu*, Yue Zhang*, **Ziyang Wang**, Jaehong Yoon, Mohit Bansal
EMNLP 2025 Findings
- 2025 **VideoTree: Adaptive Tree-based Video Representation for LLM Reasoning on Long Videos** Nashville, USA
Ziyang Wang*, Shoubin Yu*, Elias Stengel-Eskin*, Jaehong Yoon, Feng Cheng, Gedas Bertasius, Mohit Bansal
CVPR 2025
- 2025 **DAM: Dynamic Adapter Merging for Continual Video QA Learning** Tucson, USA
Feng Cheng*, **Ziyang Wang***, Yi-Lin Sung, Yan-Bo Lin, Mohit Bansal, Gedas Bertasius
WACV 2025
- 2024 **Unified Embeddings for Multimodal Retrieval via Frozen LLMs** Malta
Ziyang Wang, Heba Elfardy, Markus Dreyer, Kevin Small, Mohit Bansal
EACL 2024 (Findings)
- 2024 **A Simple LLM Framework for Long-Range Video Question-Answering** Miami, USA
Ce Zhang, Taixi Lu, Md Mohaiminul Islam, **Ziyang Wang**, Shoubin Yu, Mohit Bansal, Gedas Bertasius
EMNLP 2024 (Main)
- 2023 **Unified Coarse-to-Fine Alignment for Video-Text Retrieval** Paris, France

Ziyang Wang, Yi-Lin Sung, Feng Cheng, Gedas Bertasius, Mohit Bansal

ICCV 2023

2022 **Language-Augmented Pixel Embedding for Generalized Zero-Shot Learning**

Journal

Ziyang Wang, Yunhao Gou, Jingjing Li, Lei Zhu, Heng Tao Shen

TCSVT 2022

2021 **Region Semantically Aligned Network for Zero-Shot Learning**

Virtual

Ziyang Wang*, Yunhao Gou*, Jingjing Li, Yu Zhang, Yang Yang

CIKM 2021 (long oral)

Service

Top CV/NLP conferences

Reviewer

- Engaged in the peer-review process in ECCV, ICLR, CVPR, COLM, WACV, ACL Rolling Reviews, IJCV and so on.

T4V workshop @ CVPR 2023 & 2024 & 2025 & 2026

Organizer and Program Committee

- Co-organize the Transformers for Vision (T4V) workshop @ CVPR 2025 and 2026.
- Worked as a program committee member to help the reviewing process and other aspect of the workshop (2023 and 2024).